

Moodle Version, Theme Recommendation, and Upgrade Strategy

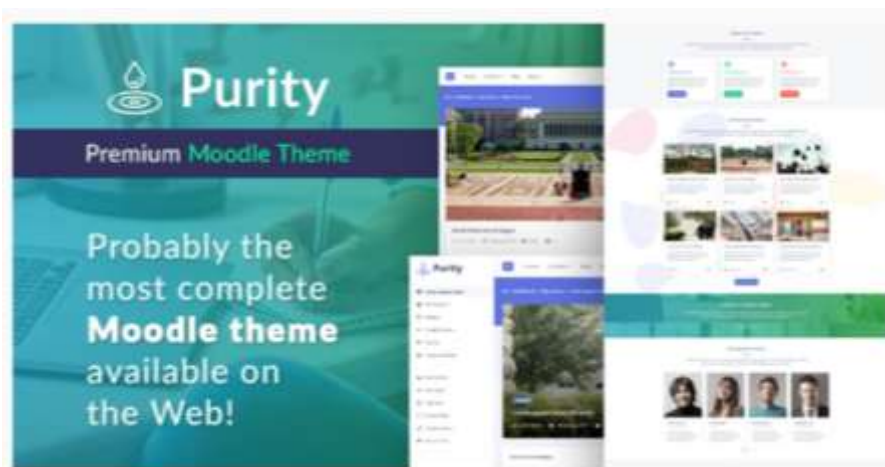
Dear Shaheryar sb.,

Thank you for your inquiry. Please find below our official guidance regarding Moodle versioning, theme selection, and upgrade strategy for your institutional academic and ERP system.

1. Moodle Version: Last Worked vs Stable

- **Last Worked Version:** Moodle 5.1 (Released October 2025)
This is the most recent release and includes significant architectural changes, including a new /public directory structure and updated server requirements (PHP 8.2+, MySQL 8.4+, MariaDB 10.11+). While powerful, it is still undergoing early adoption and plugin compatibility testing.
 - **Recommended Stable Version: Moodle 4.5 (LTS)**
Released in October 2024, Moodle 4.5 is the current **Long-Term Support (LTS)** version. It is widely adopted, thoroughly tested, and supported through October 2027. We recommend Moodle 4.5 for production deployments where stability, plugin compatibility, and long-term support are critical.
-

2. Recommended Theme: Purity



We officially recommend the **Purity Theme** for your deployment. It offers:

- **Professional UX** for academic and ERP-integrated portals

- **Responsive design** with RTL and accessibility support
- **Role-based dashboards** for students, faculty, and administrators
- **Custom branding options** including logo, color palette, and layout presets
- **Optimized performance** for large-scale deployments
- **Full compatibility** with Moodle 4.5 and 5.x

Purity is ideal for hybrid systems that combine learning management with administrative workflows. It supports modular plugin layouts and integrates well with ERP-lite dashboards.

3. Upgrade Strategy: Preserving Data During Moodle Upgrade

Yes, Moodle can be safely upgraded while retaining all existing data, including:

- Courses, users, grades, assignments
- Custom plugins and themes (subject to compatibility)
- Reports, logs, and configuration settings

Recommended Upgrade Path:

- If currently on Moodle 4.x, upgrade to **Moodle 4.5 (LTS)** for stability and long-term support.
- If planning future adoption of Moodle 5.1, we recommend staging and testing first, due to its new directory structure and stricter server requirements.

Upgrade Checklist:

- Full backup of database, moodledata, and Moodle codebase
- Plugin compatibility review (especially for ERP-lite and custom modules)
- Staging environment for upgrade testing
- Maintenance mode during upgrade
- Post-upgrade validation and user acceptance testing

We offer full support for upgrade planning, execution, and post-upgrade stabilization.

Please let us know if you'd like a tailored upgrade plan or a demo of the Purity theme in your environment. We're happy to assist with deployment and training.

Best regards,

Syed Sana ul Haq Fazli
Senior Moodle Developer